

Cup-Ji Case Competition



“Brewed for Growth: Taking Ready-to-Sip Tea from Niche Idea to National Habit”

Background:

Cup-Ji is an Indian startup founded by Aakash and Jay Sotta. The company offers an innovative tea product “**ready-to-sell tea in a disposable paper cup**”. The cup comes pre-filled with premium tea leaves sealed at the bottom; the consumer simply needs to pour hot water to prepare the tea. The product eliminates the need for tea bags, kettles, or strainers, offering convenience for on-the-go consumption.

Product Demo Link: <https://bit.ly/4jEbsx8>

Cup-Ji appeared on **Shark Tank India Season 3**, where it showcased its product and gained visibility. Post the show, the brand experienced an uptick in consumer interest and online sales. Currently, the company sells through its website, Amazon, and some offline channels.

Company Website: <https://bit.ly/43JfYo1>

The brand has gained recognition, becoming a finalist in the "Most Innovative Beverage" category at Gulfood 2022 and winning the "Best Packaging Design" award at Gulfood Innovation Awards 2025.

After the initial success of its green tea flavours, Cup-Ji has decided to introduce new **Chai** and **Coffee** products to penetrate the market and scale the business sustainably.

Cup-Ji’s new Chai and Coffee product line features convenient, ready-to-sip chai and coffee in a paper cup format. Each cup contains a pre-measured, flavorful premix that transforms with the addition of hot water. Ideal for **on-the-go consumers**, these beverages offer a **quick, high-quality experience** without the **hassle of preparation**.

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Product Links:

Chai: <https://cupji.com/products/masala-chai-pack-of-5-cups-unsweetened?variant=46612301709550>

Coffee: <https://cupji.com/products/cappuccino-bold-frothy-coffee>

The Business Problem:

Cup-Ji has validated the product concept and customer interest but is now at a critical stage where it needs to develop a clear **Go-to-Market (GTM) strategy** for its newly launched Chai and Coffee products

As part of this competition, you must help Cup-Ji answer the following key questions:

- **Target Market:** Who should be the primary target customers for Cup-Ji in India? What are the key consumer segments most likely to adopt the *Chai* and *Coffee* product?
- **Positioning & Brand Communication:** How should Cup-Ji position itself in the market? What should be its core brand message and narrative for the new products?
- **Pricing Strategy:** How should the product be priced for different channels (online, offline, institutional sales)? How can Cup-Ji justify its premium pricing to consumers?
- **Distribution Channels:** What should be the optimal mix of online and offline distribution channels for Cup-Ji? How can it achieve efficient reach?
- **Promotional Tactics:** What marketing and promotional tactics should Cup-Ji adopt to build awareness, drive trials, and encourage repeat purchases?

Your task:

Design a **comprehensive GTM plan** for Cup-Ji to help it achieve scalable growth in the Indian market. Your recommendations should be practical, data-driven, and actionable.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Depth of market & company analysis and consumer insight.
- Clarity and feasibility of strategic recommendations.
- Innovativeness and creativity in approach.
- Alignment with Cup-Ji's brand values and objectives.
- Quality and professionalism of the final presentation

Submission Details:

1. The first slide of the presentation should include your name, email ID, contact no. and the college you are associated with.
2. Submit a PowerPoint presentation/PDF covering all the necessary details in no more than 10 slides (including the first slide). You may include additional appendix slides but not more than 20 slides overall. Prefer to **submit in PDF format** so that there is no chance of formatting issue (**Max slide limit: 10, Maximum file size: 20 MB, File Type: PDF/PPT**)
3. Submission is to be done before the **communicated deadline (5th July 2025)**, beyond which no submission would be considered
4. Teams selected for the final round will have an opportunity to modify their presentations